STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP): IT SUPPORT SERVICE DELIVERY & INCIDENT MANAGEMENT

Document Reference: SOP-NTS-ITSM-001

Target Organization: NovaTech Solutions (Pty) Ltd

Scope: Internal IT Support Service Operations

Effective Date: 01 September 2026

1. Purpose & Scope

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the end-to-end lifecycle of support requests logged within NovaTech Solutions (Pty) Ltd. The goal of this process is to standardise ticket logging accuracy, ensure clear communication, and manage escalate workflows efficiently to resolve operational issues within agreed Service Level Agreement (SLAs)

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
End-User (Client/Staff)	Accurately reports issues via the Service Operations Portal using designated ticket templates
Level 1 (Support/ Helpdesk)	First-line triaging, ticket logging accuracy check, basic troubleshooting, resolution of common requests, and initial escalation
Level 2 (L2 Support/ Technical Specialists)	Advanced technical support, complex hardware or software troubleshooting, and network maintenance
Level 3 (L3 Support/ System Architects & Vendors)	Infrastructure modifications, severe critical outages, specialized vendor management, and root-cause engineering

3. **End-to-End Incident Management Life Cycle**

Step 1: Request Capture & Logging

- **Description:** The user submits a ticket via the web-based Service Operations Portal or email
- **Responsible Party:** End-User/Level 1 Support Desk
- **Purpose:** To capture detailed information (user ID, asset tag, issue category, urgency) to eliminates diagnostic delays

Step 2: Triage, Categorisation & Priority Assignment

- **Description:** L1 support reviews the ticket to verify categorization (e.g., Asset Replacement, Network Update, Change Request) and assigns a priority level based on business impact
- **Responsible Party:** Level 1 Support Desk
- **Purpose:** Ensures high-impact issues are prioritized correctly over standard administrative queries

Step 3: Initial Investigation & First-Contact Resolution (Level 1)

- **Description:** L1 technicians perform initial diagnostics using standard Knowledge Base (KB) articles and scripts. If resolved, the ticket is updated and closed
- **Responsible Party:** Level 1 Support Desk
- **Purpose**: Rapid resolution of minor issues within target response windows

Step 4: Escalation (If Unresolved)

- **Description:** If L1 cannot resolve the issue within designated bound, the ticket is reassigned to Level 2 or Level3 alongside detailed diagnostic logs
- **Responsible Party:** Level 1/Level 2/ Level 3 Technicians
- **Purpose:** Ensures complex or critical faults receive specialized technical intervention

Step 5: Resolution & Testing

- **Description:** The assigned technician applies the fix (e.g., hardware swap, patch deployment, access rights provisioning) and performs verification tests with the end-user
- **Responsible Party:** Responsible Technician (L1, L2, or L3)
- **Purpose:** Confirms the incident is completely resolved prior to closure

Step 6: Ticket Closure & Knowledge Base Documentation

- **Description:** The end-user is notified, resolution notes are recorded, and if the issue involved a novel fault, a KB entry is drafted. The ticket is officially marked as Closed
- **Responsible Party:** Level 1 Support Desk/Assignee
- **Purpose:** Maintains accurate audit trails for power BI performance metrics and ongoing service improvement

4. Expected Response & Target Resolution Times

To maintain high service availability for NovaTech Solutions, support staff must adhere to the following response metrics:

- **Level 1(First-Line Support & Basic Queries):** Initial response and resolution within 2 hours
- **Level 2 (Advanced Technical & System Maintenance):** Response and active investigation within 24 hours
- **Level 3 (Complex Cases, Core Network & Vendor Support):** Escalation response and active investigation within 48 hours (or as mandated for complex cases)

5. Escalation Criteria & Triggers

Technicians must escalate an active ticket immediately when any of the following conditions are met:

1. **Unresolved After Two Follow-ups:** Any ticket that remains unresolved after two consecutive follow-up interactions or unsuccessful diagnostic attempts must automatically escalate to the next tier
2. **Critical infrastructure Downtime:** Network, server, or core application downtime exceeding 30 minutes triggers an immediate escalation to Level 3 infrastructure specialists
3. **High Business Impact:** Outages affecting multiple departments or executive operations bypass standard L1 triage straight to Level 2/3 response workflow

6. **Escalation Flowchart**

https://lucid.app/lucidchart/52747846-0a01-456e-8e3f-605cfe31e02f/edit?viewport_loc=-2447%2C-2106%2C4898%2C2355%2C0_0&invitationId=inv_f5b3342e-8c62-4d38-8cb9-3e9ac0cb41ec

Reference List

- CompTIA (2023) CompTIA A+ Guide to IT Technical Support. 11th edn. Boston: Cenages Learning
- The Independent Institute of Education (IIE) (2026) Internal IT Support Service Improvement Project Brief: XHIS5122/p. The Independent Institute of Education (Pty) Ltd.